Working Paper
Revision of UG Students' Advisor System (SAS)
Sponsored by NUST SEECS

Background

1. Student Advisory System (SAS) was introduced to enhance students' experience and address their grievances through regular & formal sessions with designated advisors. However, certain observations/ concerns have been raised by both faculty and students during implementation of said system.

2. Faculty found it burdensome to chase students for holding SAS sessions as most students tend to skip them citing little value of such sessions. The perception is strengthened by the fact that most problems faced by students are of administrative nature beyond the scope of school and needed action at higher level. Moreover, parallel advisory/counseling channels are available to students at school/NUST level, which creates some duplication.

3. Similarly, academically sound students termed it over supervision and nonproductive. However, academically deficient students may have benefited from extra attention and regular monitoring of their academic performance.

Proposal

4. It is proposed to revise the scope of the SAS as listed below:

   (a) Mandatory for 1st year students to facilitate, guide, and groom new students during their settling down phase.

   (b) Mandatory for critical students (academically deficient who have cumulative/semester GPA less than qualifying grade or more than 1 F/XF/W grade).

   (c) Voluntary participation for other students.

(d) Any other student(s) whom Head of Institution desires to add in SAS.

5. Reporting and documentation requirements will be mandatory for critical students and fully automated within Qalam.

Implementation for 1st Year Students

6. Concerned HoD / SHoD / DCE / Dean / Designated Faculty of UG degree program will appoint one student advisor (SA) for a maximum group size of 20 students. SAs contact info is made available to all 1st year students.

7. Same SA will be assigned for the complete 1 year.

8. One lecture of 50 minutes in first week of every month be reserved for each group of students (max 20) in class schedule for interaction of students with their SA(s) with following agenda:

(a) Feedback about the quality of teaching and aids being used in the class rooms / lecture halls.

(b) Feedback about the quality of infrastructure / labs / lab equipment / lab engineers, technicians / TAs / hostels / sports facilities, etc.

(c) Any other complaints / suggestions for improving the academic environment, quality of education and support infrastructure at the college / school / NUST level.

(d) Brief students on university / school / college policies

(e) Advise students on responsible use of social media and safety aspects (COVID-19, fire hazards, weather precautions etc.)

(f) Brief students about the importance of public speaking, personality grooming, career counseling, table manners, dressing etiquettes and etc.

9. Students can also contact SA at any other time on need basis.

10. Any common/ significant problems faced by students are to be reported to HoD by the SA after each monthly session **(Appendix 'A')** for resolution or submission to higher authorities.

Implementation for Critical Students

11. Concerned HoD/SHoD/Dean will designate one SA for all critical students of each UG degree program.

(a) One SA to handle max of 10 critical cases. In case number exceeds, department to detail additional SA.

(b) Stand by SA be nominated to cover for an SA on leave.

12. Exam Br of school / college to share list of critical students with concerned HoD/SHoD/ Dean at the start of each semester.

13. SA to meet critical students during 3rd, 9th, and 15th week of the semester to guide student about study plan & maintain progress sheet on Qalam.

14. Critical students can also contact SA at any other time on need basis.

15. Parents of critical students are called for in person meeting or over phone to apprise them about student's weakness, consequences for not improving and proposed plan of studies in the 3rd week of semester.

16. In case of continued weak performance in midterm and prior to ESE, parents are to be engaged again for their intervention.

17. SA will maintain record of actions taken in respect of critical students and apprise concerned HoD within one week of activity.

Implementation for non-Critical Students (Except First Year)

18. Any other student needing advisory / counseling may approach the designated SAs or approach the concerned HoD for allocation of an SA. Head of Institution may add any student(s) to SAS system if deemed appropriate.

19. Any faculty member can recommend HoD to add in SAS a student showing exceptional behavioral issues for close supervision by SA.

20. SA contact details are to be publicized on departments' website and disseminated to students.

21. Significant concerns/issues faced by majority of student body of school/ college will be shared by concerned Head of Institute with Pro-Rector (Acad).

Monitoring

22. Concerned HoDs / SHoDs / Dean will monitor implementation of SAS and apprise Principal / Head of Institution about state of implementation at following intervals:

(a) **4th Week of Semester**: Confirm actions of designated SAs, scheduling of monthly classes for first year students and steps taken in 3rd week for critical students.

(b) **12th Week of Semester**: Confirm actions taken in 9th week for critical students and point out non-performing cases.

(c) **After ESE**: Put up consolidated list of unresolved key issues beyond the scope of school to Principal / Head of Institution for taking up with NUST Main Office.

Integration into Qalam

23. Reporting for critical students will be fully automated within Qalam.

24. Qalam will automatically identify the critical students after the results are announced as per para 4(b) or as deemed appropriate by Head of Institution.

25. Qalam will have provision to create a panel of SAs for each department/school and assignment of SAs to students.

26. SA should have access to the student's attendance record

27. Each advisor will be able to see his respective list of critical students on Qalam and their reports as given below:

a. Student's Personal and Academic History Form **(Appendix 'B')** to be made available in Qalam for new class**.** Each first year student will fill this form online during the orientation week. SA will verify that the form is filled during the first advisory class of the semester.

b. Students' Academic Progress Sheet **(Appendix 'C')** will be automatically generated in Qalam and made available to SAs.

c. Feedback Reports will be raised by the SA at the end of each semester **(Appendix 'D')** and filled online in Qalam.

d. Qalam will have provision to automatically generate Warning Letter (**Appendix 'E'**) to student's email address with copy to the SA / HoD / DCE / Principal.

28. For first year students, Qalam will have provision for department / school to assign one SA from defined panel of SAs to a group of students.

29. Qalam will facilitate attendance recording of first year students' monthly sessions by SA.

Academic workload for SAs

30. Workload of any SA for 10 or more students will be counted as 1.0 CHs and incorporated accordingly in his AAR.

Applicability

31. Said policy to be applicable with effect from Spring 2022 semester.

Review

32. Said policy to be reviewed after 1 year for any amendments if required.

Appendix A

Advisor Feedback Report: First Year UG Students Mandatory Monthly Sessions

Course/Class		**Section**				**Semester**		
Advisor Name		**School Name**				**Department**		
Attendance in Advisor Classes	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	Aggregate
Present percentage								

Students complaints/observations/suggestions, if any

Advisor Comments / Follow up (if any)

Date:_____ **(**_____**)**

Advisor Signature

Note: *SA may raise UG Critical Students' Advisor Feedback Report for any first year student, if required (showing critical deficiency etc)*

Appendix B

Student's Personal & Academic History / Record

1. Student Details					
First Name		Family Name		Student ID	
Date Joined NUST		Date of Birth		Student e-mail	
Religion		Nationality		Mobile No	

2. NUST Institution Details				
School / College			Department	
Migrating Student	YES / NO	If yes, give details		

3. Address Details	

4. Family Details					
Father's/ Guardian's Name		Occupation		Tel	
Mother's Name		Occupation		Tel	
Next of Kin Name		Relationship		Tel	

5. Own Brothers and Sisters				
S No	Full Name	Gender (M/F)	Age (Years)	Occupation

6. Technical Education (if any)				
Name of Institution	Course Title /Trade	Duration	Date Passed	Diploma Award

7. Previous Employment, if any			
Organization / Dept	Designation	Total Service	Reason for leaving

8. Any Disability	

9. Any Medical Condition								
10. Games Played								
11. Hobbies								
12. Other Interests								
13. Smoker	**Yes / No**							
14. Extra/ Co-Curricular Activities & Achievements								
15. Primary School Education (Up to 5th Class)								
(a)	Name of School							
(b)	Place / Address							
(c)	Year Passed							
(d)	Final Aggregate in 5th Class							
(e)	Distinctions, if any							
16. Middle School Education (Up to 8 th Class)								
(a)	Name of School							
(b)	Place / Address							
(c)	Medium of Instruction							
(d)	Year Passed							
(e)	Final Aggregate in 8th Class							
(f)	Distinctions, if any							
17. Matric or Equivalent (O Level)								
(a)	Name of School							
(b)	Place / Address							
(c)	Medium of Instruction							
(d)	Year Passed							
(e)	Subjects with Score / Grade	Phy		Chem		Maths		Bio
(f)	Final Aggregate 10th Class /O Lvl							
(g)	Distinctions, if any							
18. Intermediate or Equivalent (FSc or A Level)								
(a)	Name of School / College							
(b)	Place / Address							
(c)	Medium of Instruction							
(d)	Year Passed							
(e)	Subjects with Score / Grade							
(f)	Final Aggregate 12th Class/ A Lvl	Phy		Chem		Maths		Bio
(g)	Distinctions, if any							

19. Certified that the information given in paras 1 to 18 is correct to the best of my knowledge.

Signature: _____
Name: _____
Date: _____ **Student ID: _____**

Appendix C

UG Students' Academic Progress Sheet

Student Name		**Student ID**		**Semester No**	
Advisor Name		**School Name**		**Department**	

Progressive Semester /Cumulative GPA Record

	1st Sem	2nd Sem	3rd Sem	4th Sem	5th Sem	6th Sem	7th Sem	8th Sem
End Sem GPA								
Cum GPA								

Current Semester Progress

Subject	Cr Hrs	Teacher	Quizzes								Assignments				OHTs/ Mid Sem Exam			Cumulative Attendance (%)	Final Grade

Appendix D

UG Critical Students' Advisor Feedback Report

Student Name		**Student ID**		**Semester**	
Advisor Name		**School Name**		**Department**	

Feedback During the Current Semester (Please tick the appropriate box)

Student's Traits / Performance Indicators	Very Poor	Below Average	Average	Above Average	Very Good	Excellent
Social Behavior						
Determination						
Confidence						
Emotional Stability						
Communication Skills						
Time / Stress Management						
Dress /Turnout /Appearance						
Academic Progress						
Overall Attendance in Classes						
Attendance in Advisor Classes	3rd Week of Semester	9th Week of Semester	15th Week of Semester			Aggregate
Present / Absent						

Weak Areas / Challenges Identified in Academics / Discipline / Attendance / Personality Traits	
(a)	
(b)	
(c)	
(d)	

Counseling / Measures Taken to Address the Challenges (Telephonic conversations with parents /Meetings with parents thru HoD to be recorded with dates)	
(a)	
(b)	
(c)	
(d)	

Additional Comments / Follow up (if any)

Date:_____

(_____)
Advisor Signature

Appendix E

File Reference

Student Name : _____
Student ID : _____
Class / Batch : _____
Department : _____
School : _____

LETTER OF WARNING

1. NUST Regulations clearly dictate the code of academic and personal conduct that a student should exhibit during his / her studies at this prestigious university. All students are expected to follow the NUST Regulations and Policies in true letter and spirit. Any violation of these Regulations and Policies speaks low on the part of the student and is bound to lead to serious consequences. In this regard, following lapse(s) has / have been observed on your part and a very serious view of this / these violation(s) has been taken:-

[ ]* Awarded **First / Second / Third** Probation due to Cum GPA < qualifying grade ***(details below)***
[ ]* Secured Semester GPA < 1.2 ***(details below)***
[ ]* Accumulated Two / Three / Four / Five **'F' Grades** ***(details below)***
[ ]* Attendance < 75 % in a subject ***(details below)***
[ ]* Absented from three mentoring classes with your Advisor during current semester
[ ]* Absented from scheduled mentoring classes with your Advisor during current semester
[ ]* An instance of poor discipline, in violation of NUST Regulations ***(details below)***
[ ]* Other Reasons (Specify): _____
[ ]* **Details:**_____
_____
_____

2. You are hereby **WARNED** to be extra-careful in future and avoid repetition of such mal-practices at any cost. It is expected that you will improve upon your conduct and adhere to NUST Regulations in true letter and spirit. Any repeated academic / disciplinary lapses of similar nature will make you liable for strict disciplinary action, which may lead to your withdrawal or termination of your studies at NUST.

Copy to :

(a) Principal / Dean
(b) DCE / Exam Branch
(c) Student Advisor
(d) Parents

Signature : _____
Name : _____
Designation : _____
Date : _____

Note for the Competent Authority Awarding this Letter of Warning
The applicable / relevant field may please be ticked with your initials on the left